



Feature Documentation

NONPARTISAN POLITICAL & VOTER INFORMATION APP

Version 1.0 • July 2026

Platforms: iOS & Android (Expo / React Native), Web preview

Application Overview

UDecide is a mobile app that helps U.S. voters understand their government and participate in elections. It brings together a citizen's elected representatives, upcoming elections, active legislation, voter registration tools, and civic education — all presented from a strictly nonpartisan standpoint. The app never ranks parties, endorses candidates, or editorializes.

How it works

Everything in the app is driven by the user's location. After creating an account, the user provides their address; the app then tailors representatives, elections, and legislation to their federal, state, county, and city jurisdictions. A location override lets users explore any other U.S. address without changing their profile.

Technology at a glance

Layer	Description
Mobile app	Expo / React Native (iOS & Android), with a web preview build. Five-tab navigation with a native "liquid glass" tab bar on modern iOS.
API server	A Node.js (Express) backend that securely brokers sign-in, profile, representative, election, and news requests, keeping those service credentials (such as the Cicero key) on the server rather than on the device.
Data sources	Legacy UDecide member system (accounts, polls, questionnaires, news), Cicero (elected officials by address), LegiScan (state legislation), Congress.gov (federal data), Google Gemini (AI fact-checking).
Sign-in options	Email & password, or Sign in with Google (server-verified OAuth).

Contents

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Screenshots in this document were captured from the live application (web preview build) using a demo account. Native iOS/Android rendering is visually equivalent with platform-native fonts, safe areas, and tab bar treatments.

SECTION 1

Account & Sign-in

Sign In

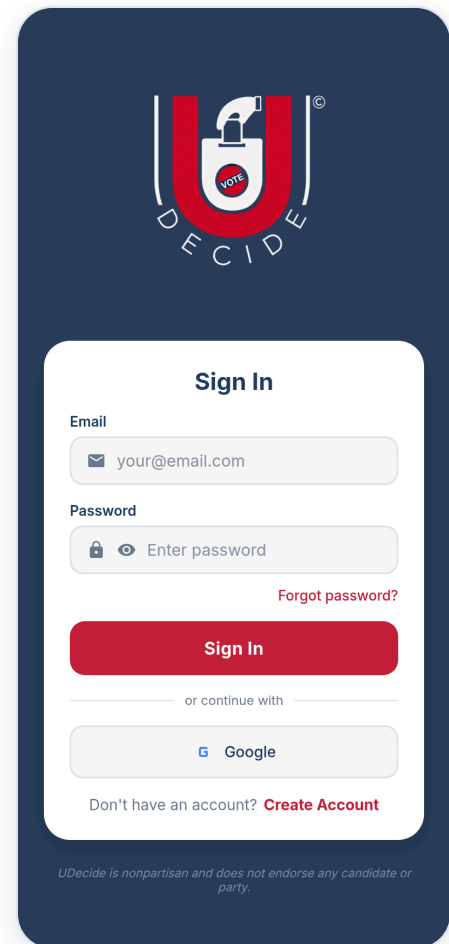
- Email + password sign-in against the UDecide member system.
- Password visibility toggle and inline validation with clear error messages.
- **Sign in with Google** — one-tap sign-in. Google verifies the identity on the server; the app can never forge an account. On the web build this opens a secure popup; on phones it uses the system browser.
- New Google users are guided through a short "Almost there" step (city + ZIP) to finish creating their account.
- Sessions persist securely on the device; users stay signed in between launches.

Create Account

- Collects name, email, password, and location (city, state, ZIP).
- Validation on every field before submission.
- After registration, a profile-setup step captures the full street address that powers representative and election matching.

Forgot Password

- Self-service reset: the user enters their account email and receives reset instructions.



The image shows a mobile app screen for signing in. At the top is the UDecide logo, which features a red 'U' with a white ballot box inside, and the word 'DECIDE' in white below it. The screen has a dark blue background. A white card in the center contains the 'Sign In' form. The form has two input fields: 'Email' with a placeholder 'your@email.com' and 'Password' with a placeholder 'Enter password'. There is a red link 'Forgot password?' next to the password field. Below the fields is a red 'Sign In' button. Underneath the button is a link 'or continue with' followed by a 'Google' button. At the bottom of the card is a link 'Don't have an account? Create Account'. At the very bottom of the screen, in small text, it says 'UDecide is nonpartisan and does not endorse any candidate or party.'

Sign In screen





Create Account

Join UDecide to access voter tools and political information

First Name

 Jane

Last Name

 Smith

Email

 your@email.com

Password

 Min. 8 characters 

Confirm Password

 Re-enter password

City

 Your city

ZIP Code

 12345

Create Account

Registration flow

Account creation runs through the secure API server to the UDecide member system. Duplicate emails and invalid entries return friendly, actionable messages. All traffic between the app and the API server is encrypted (HTTPS).



Reset Password

Enter your email and we'll send instructions to reset your password.

Email Address

 your@email.com

Send Reset Instructions

Back to Sign In

Forgot Password

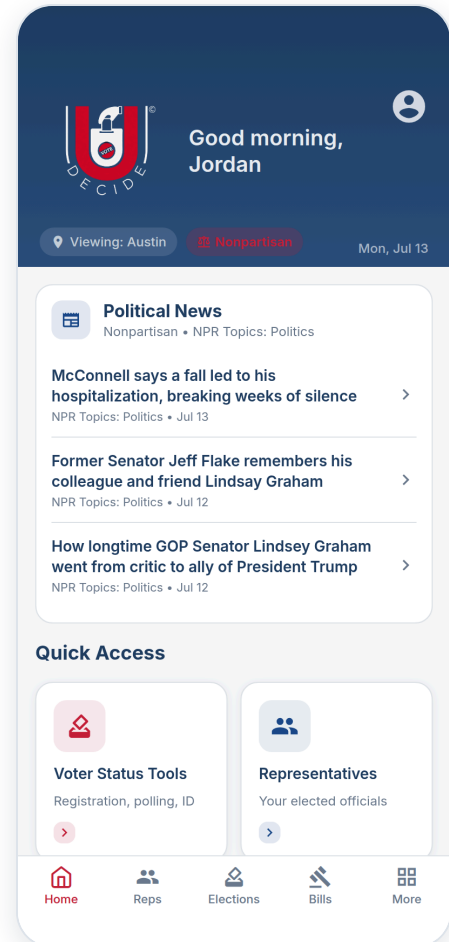
SECTION 2

Dashboard (Home)

The dashboard is the user's civic home base — a card-driven layout that surfaces the most relevant information and provides one-tap access to every feature.

- Personalized greeting and the user's current civic location.
- Quick-access cards to Representatives, Elections, Legislation, Voter Tools, Polls, Fact Checker, and more.
- Political news access via the member news feed, opened as readable in-app articles.
- Reference links (state/town resources) supplied by the member system.
- Nonpartisanship notice reinforcing the app's neutral stance.

All personalized content follows the user's **effective location** — their profile address, or the temporary override set in Location Override (Section 12).



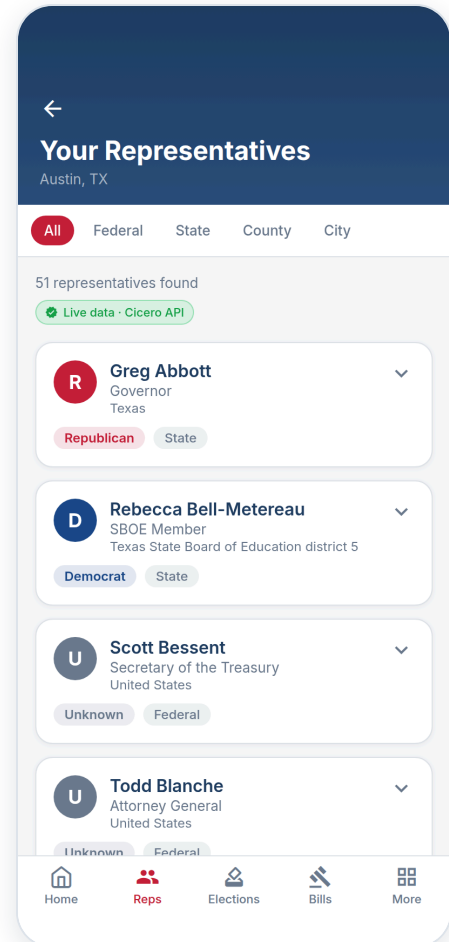
Dashboard

SECTION 3

Representatives

See every elected official who represents you — from the President down to city council — based on your exact address.

- Officials grouped by level: **Federal, State, County, City** with an easy filter row.
- Live data from the Cicero civic-data service, requested securely through the API server.
- Each official shows their photo, office, party affiliation, and contact channels (phone, email, website, social).
- Detail view includes term information and, where available, voting-record context.
- Updates automatically when the user's effective location changes.



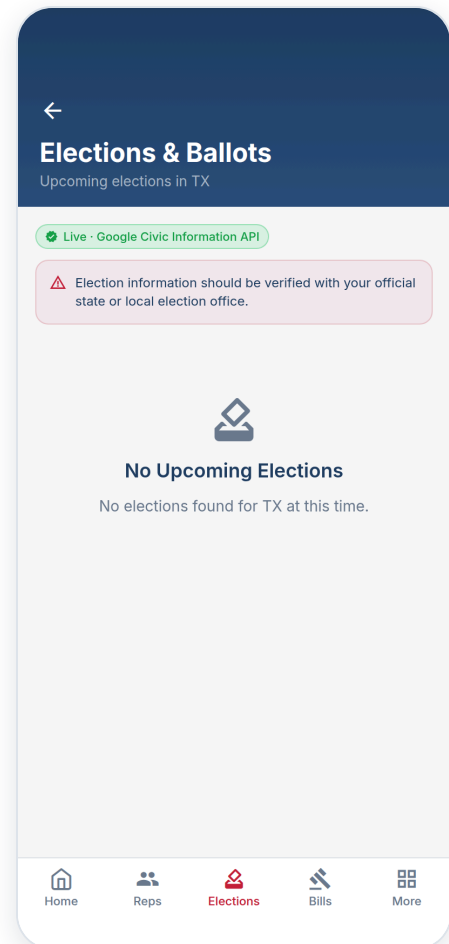
Representatives tab

SECTION 4

Elections & Ballots

A forward-looking view of every election that affects the user, with the practical details needed to participate.

- Upcoming federal, state, and local elections for the user's jurisdictions.
- Key dates: election day, registration deadlines, early-voting windows, and absentee deadlines.
- Candidate listings presented neutrally — no endorsements or rankings.
- Countdown context so users know how soon each election is.



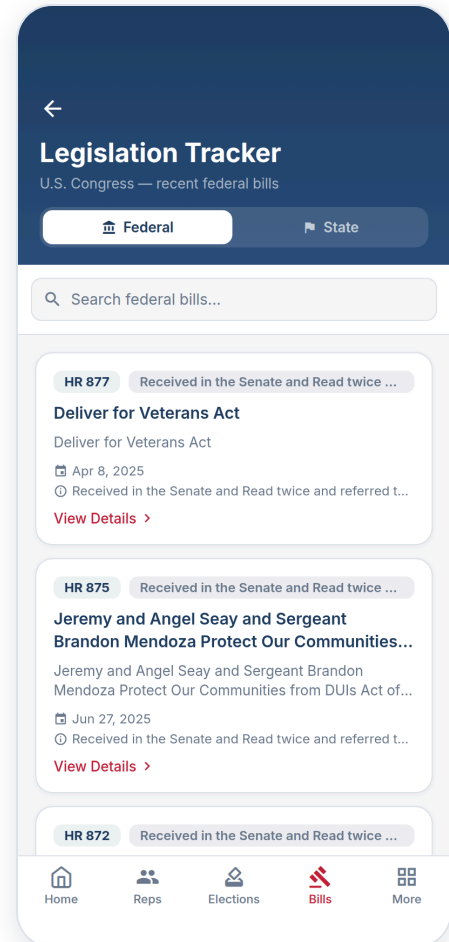
Elections tab

SECTION 5

Legislation Tracker

Follow bills as they move through the user's state legislature and Congress.

- State legislation from the LegiScan service; federal data from Congress.gov.
- Bill cards show number, title, plain-language status (Introduced, In Committee, Passed, Signed, etc.), and last action.
- Search and filtering to find bills by topic.
- Detail view summarizes the bill and its progress timeline.



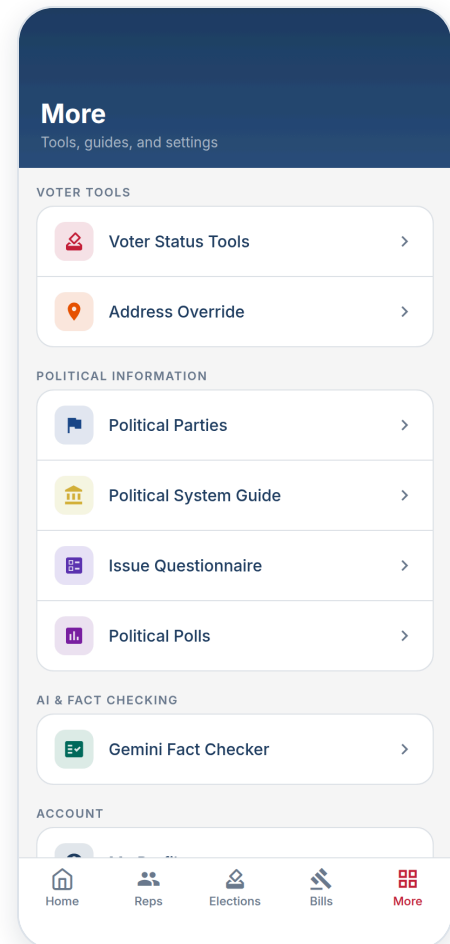
Legislation tab

SECTION 6

More Menu

The fifth tab collects the app's remaining tools and account controls in one organized menu.

- Voter Tools, Political Parties, Political System Guide, Civics Quiz, Polls, Issue Questionnaire, and the AI Fact Checker.
- Profile management and Location Override.
- Static informational pages (about, terms, privacy) provided by the member system.
- Sign out.



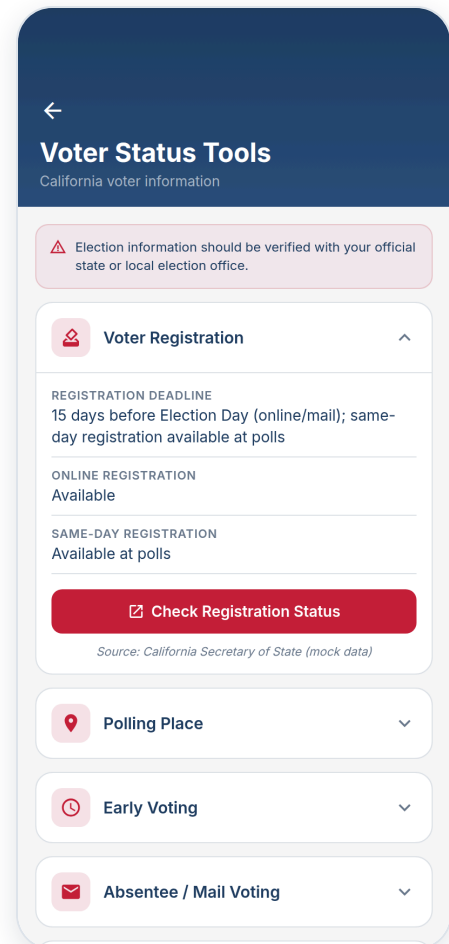
More tab

SECTION 7

Voter Tools

Practical, state-aware guidance that turns intent into a cast ballot.

- Voter-registration status guidance and links to official state registration resources.
- Polling-place information for the user's address.
- Absentee / mail-in voting rules and deadlines for the user's state.
- Early-voting availability and windows.
- ID requirements and what to bring on election day.



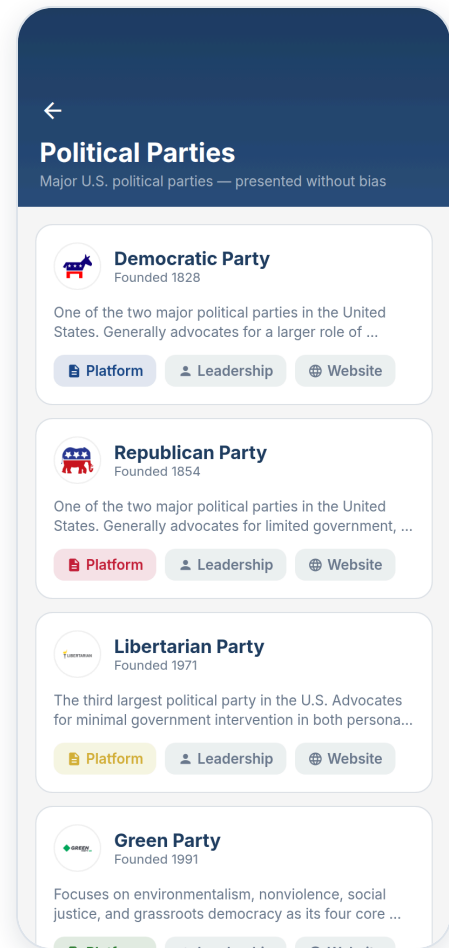
Voter Tools

SECTION 8

Political Parties

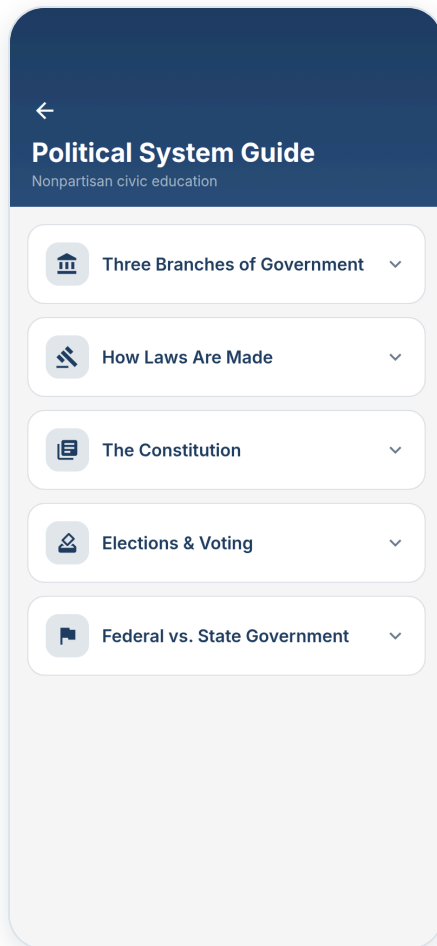
A balanced reference on America's political parties.

- Profiles of the major and notable minor parties.
- Neutral platform summaries — history, core positions, and organization.
- Identical presentation for every party: no ordering by preference, no rankings, no commentary.



Political Parties

Political System Guide & Civics Quiz



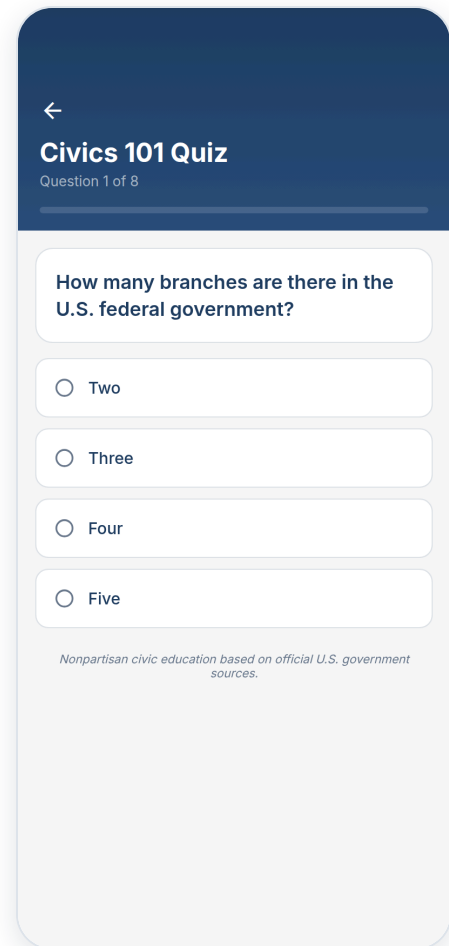
Political System Guide

Political System Guide

- Civic-education explainers: the three branches of government, how a bill becomes law, the Constitution and amendments, and how elections work.
- Written in plain language for readers of any background.

Civics Quiz

- An interactive quiz that lets users test their civic knowledge.
- Instant feedback per question and a score summary at the end.



Civics Quiz

Polls & Issue Questionnaires

←

Political Polls

Community perspectives — not scientific unless stated

All Economy Healthcare Immigration Education

Civic Engagement 787 votes

How important is increasing voter turnout in your community?

Critically important

Somewhat important

Neutral

Not important

Tap an option to vote

Community poll — results reflect app users and are not a scientific sample.

Local Issues 1.0K votes

Which local issue matters most to you this year?

Education

Infrastructure & roads

Community Polls

Community Polls

- Members vote on current civic questions from the UDecide community.
- One vote per member per poll; results are viewable after voting.
- Live results with vote counts and percentages.

Issue Questionnaires

- Structured issue sets that let users record where they stand on policy topics.
- Stances are private to the user — an informational self-assessment, not a public poll.

←

Issue Questionnaire

Explore where you stand on the issues

Education Issues Environmental Issues Economic Issues

QUESTION 1

Do you support increasing taxes for the rich in order to reduce interest rates for student loans?

No, and transition all current government student loans into privately managed accounts

No, but we should still reduce interest rates for student loans

Yes, and increase government funding so every student receives a free college education

No

Yes

QUESTION 2

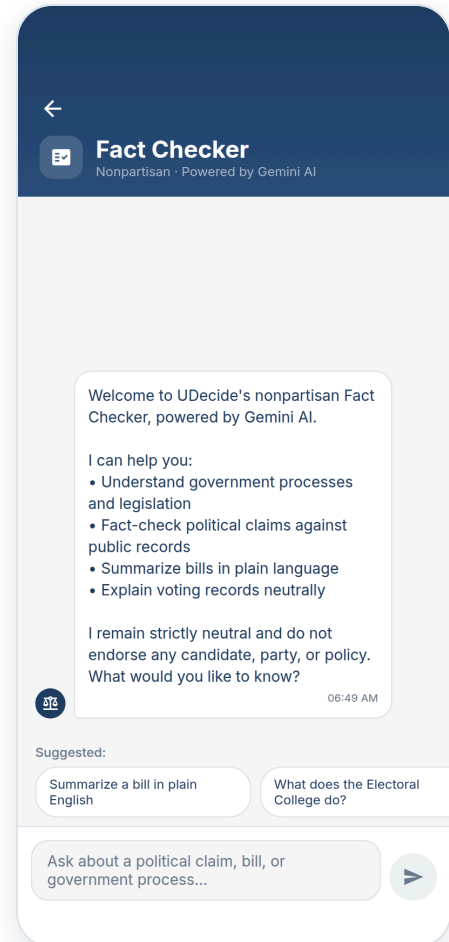
Should the federal government pay for tuition at four-year colleges and universities?

Issue Questionnaire

AI Fact Checker

A conversational assistant, powered by Google's Gemini AI, purpose-built for neutral political fact-checking.

- Users paste a claim or ask a question; the assistant responds with factual, sourced-style context.
- A strict nonpartisan system prompt keeps answers neutral — the assistant describes, it never advocates.
- Streaming, chat-style interface with conversation history during the session.
- Clear disclaimer that AI answers are informational and users should verify with primary sources.



AI Fact Checker

Profile & Location Override

←

J

Jordan Smith

uddocs_1783924294@example.com

Account Information

First Name
Jordan

Last Name
Smith

Email
uddocs_1783924294@example.com

Address
Not set

City
Austin

State

ZIP Code
78701

Account Settings

Edit Profile

Profile

Profile

- Edit name, contact details, and the home address that drives all location-based features.
- Profile photo upload from the device photo library.
- Changes save to the UDecide member system and take effect across the app immediately.

Location Override

- Explore the political landscape of **any U.S. address** — representatives, elections, and legislation for that location — without changing the saved profile.
- A visible indicator shows when an override is active; one tap returns to the home address.

←

Address Override

View political data for a different location without changing your profile

Use address override to explore representatives, elections, and legislation from any U.S. location. A banner will display while override is active. Your profile address is unchanged.

Set Override Location

Street Address
123 Main Street

City
Washington

State (2-letter)
DC

ZIP Code
20001

Apply Override

Location Override